RSS Digest
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1. Hello Python 3.15, goodbye 3.10, and now I can use 3.11
Source: Simon Willison’s Weblog | Published: 2026-10-12T18:15:38+00:00
Link: https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/12/python-3-15/
Python 3.15 is here ! Here’s the essential What’s new in Python 3.15 guide, this year curated by 3.14 and 3.15 release manager Hugo van Kemenade. As someone who builds open source software that works in every supported Python version, I get to say goodbye to Python 3.10 and start embracing features from Python 3.11. First, some highlights from Python 3.15. Explicit lazy imports I’m most excited about Explicit lazy imports from PEP 810 . These let you import modules like so: lazy import json lazy from pathlib import Path The module will then be imported the first time those symbols are used in the code that follows. My LLM CLI tool implements plugins. I had to recommend manual lazy imports in the plugin author documentation, because simply installing plugins that used heavy dependencies such as sentence_transformers could add multiple seconds to every invocation of the llm command. Lazy imports directly address this startup cost. Unpacking in comprehensions The new [*sublist for sublist in lists] unpacking syntax is neat. Here’s an illustration lifted from the documentation : lists = [[1 , 2], [3 , 4], [5]] [* L for L in lists] # [1, 2, 3, 4, 5] # equivalent to [x for L in...

2. web-edit 0.1a0
Source: Simon Willison’s Weblog | Published: 2026-10-12T15:54:36+00:00
Link: https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/12/web-edit/
Release: web-edit 0.1a0 I was working on a project from my phone using Codex Remote when I found myself wanting to edit a credentials file without round-tripping those credentials through the LLM itself. So... I had Codex and GPT-6 Astra Extra High build this Python web app which provides a web UI for viewing and editing files in a folder. It’s intended to be run over Tailscale, so I can have an agent start this running and then edit files via my Tailscale network directly from my phone. Here’s the interface for browsing files in a folder: Editing uses CodeMirror 6 - I was going to use Monaco but that still doesn’t have a great mobile experience yet. Tags: projects , python , ai , tailscale , generative-ai , llms , codex

3. datasette-ports 0.4
Source: Simon Willison’s Weblog | Published: 2026-10-12T04:57:07+00:00
Link: https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/12/datasette-ports/
Release: datasette-ports 0.4 My plugin for detecting and listing all Datasette instances on the current machine now works with the latest version, and displays the detected PID as well. Knowing the PID makes it easier to attach the new Python 3.15 profiler . Tags: datasette

4. Software engineers don’t get to be Luddites about AI
Source: seangoedecke.com RSS feed | Published: Mon, 12 Oct 2026 00:00:00 GMT
Link: https://seangoedecke.com/software-engineers-dont-get-to-be-luddites-about-ai/
Many software engineers are righteously angry about AI. It?s understandable to be upset that the skills you built your professional identity around are getting automated away. But software engineers are the last people in the world who should be complaining about this. If you live by the sword, you will perish by the sword 1 . Software engineering has always automated industries From the very beginning, software engineering has been about automating other people?s work. Every single commercial software program 2 is valuable because it takes over some task you would have to pay a human to do. The engineer who built VisiCalc, one of the first pieces of personal commercial software, agonized over the potential of the spreadsheet to put bookkeepers out of work. Here is a brief list of industries software engineers have automated away 3 : Video rental stores Business directories and encyclopaedias Typesetting companies Travel agencies Record stores Typing pools Data-entry Trading-floor runners Now that it?s our turn, should we bluster and complain that software engineering is a priceless art that should not be automated? Come off it. No crying in the casino. The Luddites and the mechan...

5. C++ futures part 1: The mental model
Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Mon, 12 Oct 2026 14:00:00 +0000
Link: https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20261012-00/?p=112767/
Managing a value that is produced later. The post C++ futures part 1: The mental model appeared first on The Old New Thing .

6. Mark Stephens, a.k.a. Robert X. Cringely, Died at 73
Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-10-12T16:43:46Z
Link: https://www.facebook.com/story.php?story_fbid=pfbid0YbCLrAJfBirAWuPBy4a7pauaQ6gHkAPUwtbzyg2wAjeMcruFC7dWUZKQJKkNChP9l&id=536506060&_rdr
Mary Alyce Stephens (nØe Neader), posting on Cringely?s Facebook account: Hello, this is Mary Alyce, Bob?s wife. I am coming to you with immense sadness to let you know that Bob passed away. His obituary follows. His family is not requesting anything, however, if you would like to make a donation in his honor, please consider The American Heart Association or The American SIDS Institute . [...] Writing as Robert X. Cringely, Mark became a distinctive voice in technology journalism. He had an unusual ability to understand not only technology but also the human beings behind it ? the dreamers, inventors, entrepreneurs, eccentrics, and risk-takers who were changing the world. He could take a complicated subject and make it understandable, entertaining, funny, and deeply human. He was skeptical when skepticism was warranted, irreverent when others were overly serious, and never particularly interested in following conventional wisdom. That independence was not simply part of his writing. It was Mark. He followed the beat of his own drummer throughout his life. He was brilliant, funny, opinionated, curious, generous, exasperating, and unforgettable ? sometimes all within the same conve...

7. Categorical models of logics
Source: John D. Cook | Published: Mon, 12 Oct 2026 13:04:09 +0000
Link: https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/10/12/categorical-models-of-logics/
A few days ago I wrote about topological models of modal logic. If you find general topology more familiar than modal logic, this correspondence could be helpful. If you think the motivation for general topology is evident but the motivation for modal logic is suspect, the correspondence between the two fields might relieve some of [?] The post Categorical models of logics first appeared on John D. Cook .

8. Now That?s What I Call Technical Debt!
Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-10-12T09:00:00+00:00
Link: https://nesbitt.io/2026/10/12/now-thats-what-i-call-technical-debt.html
?I haven?t listened to it, but you?re absolutely right to release it.? MC OpenClaw 1. All Star (Maintainer?s Version) Smash Mouth: All Star The PRs start coming and they don?t stop coming, Bots keep shipping and the tests keep running. Only made sense to automate, Now I?m reviewing slop at a staggering rate. So much to merge, so much to break, So what?s wrong with another rewrite? You?ll never know if you don?t deploy, You?ll never care if you?re not employed. 2. Should I Merge or Should I Close? The Clash: Should I Stay or Should I Go Should I merge or should I close? Every comment starts another row. You changed the API again, And broke the tests that passed at ten. If I merge, the build explodes, If I close, the outrage grows. 3. Another One Breaks the Build Queen: Another One Bites the Dust Another PR, another day, Another green check fades away. The tests were passing yesterday, Now nobody knows what changed. Another one breaks the build, Another one breaks the build. Three more merged while I was asleep, And another one breaks the build. 4. Smells Like AI Slop Nirvana: Smells Like Teen Spirit Load the prompt and bring your friends, Another patch that never ends. Ten new file...

9. Pluralistic: How labor rights rescued Ultima from a monopolist (12 Oct 2026)
Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Mon, 12 Oct 2026 11:40:39 +0000
Link: https://pluralistic.net/2026/10/12/termination-of-transfer/

Today’s links How labor rights rescued Ultima from a monopolist: If you care about labor justice and artists’ rights, stop focusing on copyright. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: China unblocks Wikipedia; CCC cracks the Bundestrojaner; "Children of the Sky"; "Messy"; Every top Icelandic banker is guilty; Climate activism x digital activism; Gene Kan on P2P’s future; Larry Ellison x mass surveillance; W3C v patents; "Work from home" in the cybercrime supply-chain; "Nursery Rhyme Comics"; Glitchy tea-set; Tourist Guy; Vista v reinstallation; Ryanair v your bladder; Wells Fargo CEO loves "sales culture"; "Attention Merchants"; Orban v free press; AI v GIGO; Dylan wins the Nobel; India’s starving kids app; Adobe’s spyware copyfraud; Charter blackmails customers with bad credit threats; Fix UK housing. Upcoming appearances: Paris, Vancouver, Victoria, Ottawa, Kilkenny, Sheffield, Oxford, Montreal. Recent appearances: Where I’ve been. Latest books: You keep readin’ em, I’ll keep writin’ ’em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I’ll keep writin’ ’em. Colophon: All the rest. How labor rights rescued Ultima from a monopolist (permalink) If you work in the media, you hav...

10. The Dock on Mac, From OS 10 to macOS 27
Source: Jim Nielsen?s Blog | Published: Mon, 12 Oct 2026 19:00:00 GMT
Link: https://blog.jim-nielsen.com/2026/macos-dock-icons-over-time/
I wrote the chapter on app icon history for The iOS App Icon Book . The other day I found an old note stashed away where I had started researching the macOS version of that chapter (which Michael ultimately ended up writing). At the time, I didn?t know what to write. I mean, how do you write a history of icon design for the Mac? It?s rich! To get my creative juices flowing, I started by researching the different docks in macOS through the years and compiled them all into a single graphic (big shout out to this compilation of images on 512 Pixels). I just wanted to preserve and archive that image. Check out the high-res version here . That?s it, that?s the post. Reply via: Email • Mastodon • Bluesky

11. The X is Off-Target
Source: Tedium: The Dull Side of the Internet. | Published: 2026-10-12T15:53:18Z
Link: https://feed.tedium.co/link/15204/17494770/x-social-media-monoliths-critique
Is X good again? That’s probably the wrong question. The right one: Are we past the era when a single social network needs to be everything to everyone?

12. from plesiochronous to synchronous
Source: computers are bad | Published: 12 Oct 2026 00:00:00 UT
Link: https://computer.rip/2026-10-12-plesiochronous.html
Up until the 1960s, telephone calls were carried as analog signals. There was a great deal of frequency division multiplexing onto open wire , and sometimes coaxial cables , but in the post-war period buried multipair telephone cables began to dominate. While the network was surprisingly functional?long distance calls from coast to coast were still quite intelligible?there were fundamental limitations to analog carriers. The quality of the call would degrade with each step, a problem that was much more acute for the sensitive digital connections that were already the apparent future of the telephone system. These were digital signals modulated over the top of telephone lines: the telephone system itself still handled them as analog calls, just ones that required special care for quality. During the Second World War, it became apparent that many of the long distance network’s challenges could be greatly simplified by using digital signaling as the basis of the entire long distance system. In 1943, Bell Labs contributed to the design of an early encrypted voice communications system called SIGSALY. Unlike the "voice scramblers" and other analog techniques of the early phase of the w...